

THE MOTION

This Club Would

make eligibility for the legal and financial benefits of marriage conditional on having a child within five years of marriage

MARK WHERE YOU STAND, NOW AND ON THE WAY OUT AS IT IS ☐ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ TIE TO CHILDREN

WHAT THE WORDS MEAN

LEGAL AND FINANCIAL BENEFITS

What the state gives spouses and not unmarried partners: inheritance without a will, a family pension, tax free gifts, maintenance, spousal visas.

HAVING A CHILD

By birth or by adoption. An adopted child counts.

WITHIN FIVE YEARS

Counted from the wedding. A couple without a child by then stays married and lives as it likes. Only the benefits are at stake.

THE REAL DISAGREEMENT

BOTH SIDES AGREE

India's birth rate is below replacement, and the state already treats married couples differently from everyone else. Nobody wants the state ending marriages.

THEY SPLIT ON

Where does a marriage get its value: the bond between two people, or raising the next generation?

WHERE EACH SIDE STARTS

FOR THE MOTION

The state backs marriage because families raise the next generation. Benefits for couples who don't raise one are a subsidy with no return.

AGAINST

The benefits protect the partner, not the children. That promise is worth the same without a child, and a five year clock punishes infertility and marrying late.

TAKING THE FLOOR

- 1 Write it down before you raise your hand. If it does not fit in one sentence, it is not ready.
- 2 One question at a time, put to the room and not to one person. If you have several, pick the best.
- 3 Sharp and specific. The best questions are not opinions in disguise. They are ones the other side has to answer.
- 4 No anecdotes. We are stress-testing arguments, not swapping experiences. If it opens with "I once knew someone who", hold it.
- 5 A warning at sixty seconds, a hard cutoff at ninety. The buzzer is not a suggestion.

WRITE IT DOWN FIRST

Draft while you listen. One sentence each, and if it does not fit on the line it is not ready.

1

2

THE ONE YOU WILL ASK

Pick the best of them. One question, put to the room.